

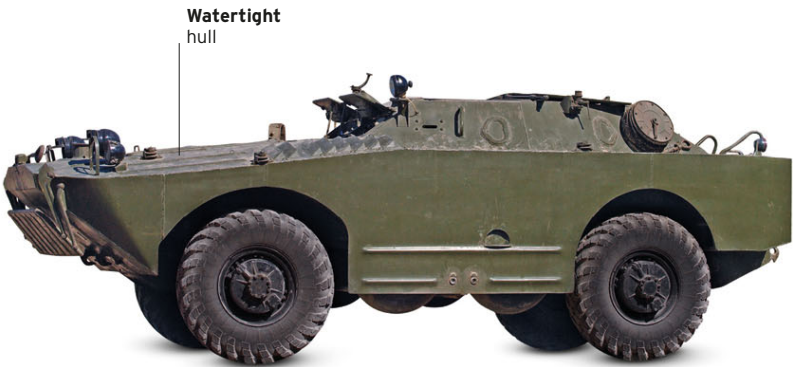
Armored Reconnaissance Vehicles

Reconnaissance vehicles were not intended to fight, but to find enemy forces and report back. This role drove their design, which emphasized mobility over protection to the point that many were light enough to float across rivers. They were armed with machine guns or light cannon designed for self-defense only—their main weapon was still the radio. Wheeled vehicles allowed for a faster and quieter mobility, although their limitations on rough terrain led to several countries using tracked vehicles instead.

▷ **FV701(E) Ferret Mark 2/5**

Date	1952	Country	UK
Weight	4.8 tons (4.4 tonnes)		
Engine	Rolls-Royce B60 Mark 6A gasoline, 129 hp		
Main armament	.30 Browning M1919 machine gun		

The development of Ferret began in 1947 as a replacement for the successful Dingo. The Mark I had an open top like the Dingo, but most had a machine gun turret, as here. Its main roles were reconnaissance and liaison, but some variants carried antitank missiles. A total of 4,409 were built, finding service in more than 30 countries.



△ **BRDM 1**

Date	1957	Country	Soviet Union
Weight	6.2 tons (5.6 tonnes)		
Engine	GAZ-40P gasoline, 90 hp		
Main armament	7.62 mm SGMB machine gun		

The BRDM 1 was fully amphibious. It was powered by a water jet, had four-wheel drive, and had four extra wheels under the belly that could be lowered on rough ground. Its variants included Nuclear, Biological, Chemical (NBC) reconnaissance and command vehicles, and a variety of antitank missile launchers. The BRDM 1 was exported to around 50 countries.



▽ **BRDM 2**

Date	1962	Country	Soviet Union
Weight	7.7 tons (7 tonnes)		
Engine	GAZ-41 V8 gasoline, 140 hp		
Main armament	14.5 mm KPVT machine gun		

Many limitations of the BRDM-1 were corrected in its successor, the BRDM 2. This featured an NBC protection system, better sights, and an armored turret housing its machine gun. It retained the BRDM-1's belly wheels and its amphibious capability.



△ **Schutzenpanzer (SPz) 11.2**

Date	1958	Country	France, West Germany
Weight	9.1 tons (8.2 tonnes)		
Engine	Hotchkiss 6-cylinder gasoline, 164 hp		
Main armament	20 mm Hispano-Suiza HS.820 cannon		

A French design, only adopted by West Germany, the SPz 11.2 was mainly used for reconnaissance, with variants employed as mortar carriers, artillery forward observation and command vehicles, and ambulances. More than 2,300 were built, serving until 1982.

